

Do bear in mind that the minimum hardware requirements that you must have in order to get smooth performance will be higher than on Windows, due to the extra processes involved in converting DirectX commands to OpenGL.

You can also try and install some Windows applications through Cedega. Not all of them work, however: while some of them may not even install properly, some will not work properly. So don't expect the world from Cedega. However, full marks to them for the effort they have put in. What we can safely say is that the day is not far off when programs written for one platform will be able to work on another platform with ease.

6.4.2 Wine

No, we're not talking about the drink! Wine is an application that creates a Windows-like environment for Windows-based software to run on. WineHQ, the makers of Wine, claim that their software can make several Windows applications run—including games! Paint Shop Pro, FrontPage and Microsoft Money are just some of the applications that can be made to work on Linux using Wine. Like Cedega, users of Wine can vote about what software that they would want Wine to support in future.

The current version of Wine is 0.9.8, and it can be downloaded from WineHQ's Web site, www.winehq.org/site/download

The good part is that there are several Linux versions supported. The bad part is that the software is not perfect as yet. As WineHQ themselves say "Wine is still under development, and it is not yet suitable for general use. Nevertheless, many people find it useful in running a growing number of Windows programs."

But don't let that deter you from experimenting with it! For all you know, you just might get your favourite Windows program running on Linux as well!